Does the live coach praise only the moves that earn it?

Held praise, read by the engine's verdict at the live budgets, replayed on the player's archive

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Abstract

The live coach praises two habits the moment a move lands, from the board alone: castling by move 8, and an even trade while ahead. A change to the app holds that praise until the engine's verdict on the move arrives, and shows it only when the verdict is a plain good one under the praise bar of 2 win%. Replayed on the player's archive at the change's own live budgets, 289 of his moves held praise. Without the gate, 24% of them would have been praised although the archive's deeper reading says they gave away 2 win% or more, and 9% although they gave away 5 or more. With it, 6.4% of the praised moves are faulted (95% interval 3.8–10.7) and one is clearly faulted, while 86% of the moves the archive reads as fine keep their praise. By the rule fixed before the run, at most one in twenty praised moves faulted and at least three in four fine moves praised, the gate meets the second bar and misses the first narrowly. What it still praises sits at the bar, where a live search and the archive's deeper one disagree as often in one direction as the other. Read after the fact, a live bar of 1 win% would sit just inside both bars on these games; the next round tests it on games played after this run.

1 The question

In a coached game the live coach writes notes the moment a move lands. Two of them praise a habit: castling by move 8, and an even trade while he is ahead, which the coach says only under the Won-Game Protocol. Those notes read only the board, so they praised a castle that passed up a capture attacking two pieces (Figure 1) as warmly as a good one. The change measured here, at commit `5fb30d9f81`, holds their praise for the engine's verdict on the move. The praise stands only when the verdict is a plain good one (the engine's own move, or a good one that gives up less than the praise bar of 2 win%), and for a trade only when the trade still reads as a trade while ahead.

Two numbers decide whether the gate does its job: how much of the praise it lets through went to moves that gave something away, and how much praise it withholds from moves that did not.

2 How it was measured

The moves. The player's archive at that commit holds 634 games, with 19,918 moves of his. Each game is replayed from the start through the change's own instant rules, under the coached game's policy. A move is in the study when a rule holds praise on it: 201 castles by move 8 and 88 even trades while ahead, 289 in all. The coach switches the Won-Game Protocol on from its verdict on his previous move; the replay reads that position from the archive's evaluation of it.

The verdict. Each move gets the change's own verdict through the app's Node engine service: the position before the move at the budget that names moves to him (600,000 nodes, three lines),

the position after it at the check budget (120,000 nodes), one thread, the same Stockfish build and the same budgets as on a phone or a desktop. Each move is searched from a cleared hash, so a rerun repeats every count. A held note is praised when the change's own test says the verdict confirms it. No move in the study had seven pieces or fewer, so the tablebase, which the coach asks there, never speaks.

The reference. The archive's own reading of the same move: the routine's sweep searched every position at 1,000,000 nodes, which gives the win% each move gave away on the app's curve. A move is *faulted* when it gave away 2 win% or more, the praise bar, and *clearly faulted* at 5 or more, an inaccuracy or worse on the judge's scale.

The rule, fixed before the first run. The gate works when, among the moves it praises, at most one in twenty is faulted, and it praises at least three in four of the moves the archive reads as not faulted. Shares carry 95% Wilson intervals.

3 What the gate does

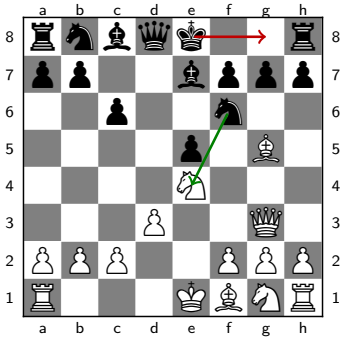
			Faulted ($\geq$ 2 win%)		Clearly faulted ($\geq$ 5)		
Rule	Moves	Praised	of all	of praised	of all	of praised	Fine praised
Castling by move 8	201	133 (66.2%)	57 (28.4%)	9 (6.8%)	20 (10.0%)	0 (0.0%)	124 (86.1%)
Even trade while ahead	88	69 (78.4%)	13 (14.8%)	4 (5.8%)	6 (6.8%)	1 (1.4%)	65 (86.7%)
Both	289	202 (69.9%)	70 (24.2%)	13 (6.4%)	26 (9.0%)	1 (0.5%)	189 (86.3%)

Table 1: His moves where an instant rule held praise, read by the change's verdict at the live budgets and by the archive's deeper reading of the same move. *Of all* is what the instant rules alone would have praised; *of praised* is what the gate lets through. *Fine moves praised*: of the moves that gave away under 2 win% by the archive's reading, the share the gate praises.

It takes most of the faulted praise away. The instant rules alone would have praised all 289 moves: 70 of them (24%) faulted and 26 (9%) clearly faulted. The gate praises 202, and 13 of those are faulted, 6.4% (95% interval 3.8–10.7), and one is clearly faulted: a trade made while winning, which the archive's own classifier calls good. No castle it praises is clearly faulted. Of the 70 faulted moves, it withholds praise from 57 (81%).

It keeps most of the earned praise. Of the 219 moves the archive reads as fine, the gate praises 189 (86%, 81.1–90.2). Of the 87 moves it withholds praise from, 70 lost too much by the live verdict's reading and 15 drew a judgment short of good. With the gate, castling praise reaches 66% of his early castles; of the 68 it withholds, 48 are faulted by the archive.

By the rule fixed before the run, it does not yet work. The second bar is met; the first is not, at 6.4% against one in twenty, and neither rule meets it alone (castles 6.8%, trades 5.8%). The interval reaches below the bar, so these games cannot say the gate is far from it either.



FEN `rnbqk2r/pp2bppp/2p2n2/4p1B1/4N3/3P2Q1/PPP2PPP/R3KBNR b KQkq - 4 7`

Figure 1: The castle with the largest loss the gate withheld. He castled, 7... O-O (`e8g8`), by move 8, and the instant rule alone would have praised it. The engine's move was 7... ♘xe4 (`f6e4`), which takes the knight and then attacks the bishop on g5 and the queen on g3. The live verdict reads the castle as a blunder that gave away 25.6 win%; the archive reads it as a miss that gave away 28.2.

4 Where the faulted praise sits

Every faulted move the gate praises gave away between 2.3 and 7.5 win% by the archive's reading, the castles no more than 3.6, and the archive's own classifier calls each of them good or best. All but one of them were among the engine's three lines in the live search, so their loss is the gap between two lines of the naming search; the other was read by the check after the move. The live and archive readings of the same move differ by a median of 0.5 win% and by 1.8 at the 90th percentile, and they put a move on different sides of the bar about as often each way: 15 moves are faulted only by the live verdict, 15 only by the archive. What the gate still praises is the disagreement between a 600,000-node search and a 1,000,000-node one at a bar of 2 win%, not moves the archive itself calls errors.

Live bar (win%)	Praised	Faulted of praised	95% interval	Fine moves praised	95% interval
0.5	146	4 (2.7%)	1.1–6.8	142 (64.8%)	58.3–70.9
1.0	181	9 (5.0%)	2.6–9.2	172 (78.5%)	72.6–83.5
1.5	197	12 (6.1%)	3.5–10.3	185 (84.5%)	79.1–88.7
2.0 (as built)	202	13 (6.4%)	3.8–10.7	189 (86.3%)	81.1–90.2

Table 2: The same moves, praised only when the gate praises them and the live loss is also under the bar. The bars were chosen after the run, so this table describes these games; it does not test a rule.

A stricter bar, read after the fact. Table 2 reads the same moves at stricter live bars. At 1 win%, the faulted share of the praise falls to 5.0% and the gate still praises 79% of the fine moves: inside both bars, just. At 0.5 win% it praises only 65%. These bars were chosen after seeing these games, so the 1 win% bar is a candidate for the next round, not a finding.

5 What it means for the app

1. The gate does what it is for on the clear cases. The instant rules alone would praise the castle in Figure 1, which passes up a capture that attacks two pieces; the gate withholds that praise, and of the 26 clearly faulted moves the rules held praise on, it praises one.

2. As built it misses the bar of one in twenty narrowly, and what it lets through sits at the praise bar, inside the noise of the live search.

3. If that bar must hold, a deeper check after the move will not reach it: all but one of the faulted praised moves were read from the naming search's own lines, which the check does not touch. A stricter bar for held praise, or a deeper naming search, would.

4. A held-praise bar of 1 win% would meet both bars on these games. It should be adopted only if the next round, on games these numbers have not seen, agrees.

6 Limits

The reference is itself a search of bounded depth, so at the bar neither reading is the truth; the gate is measured against the deeper one. The games are one player's, and the trades are few enough that their row's intervals are wide. The Won-Game Protocol is read from the archive's evaluation of his previous move, where the coach reads it from its own verdict, so a trade near the protocol's line can fall in or out. In play the engine's hash holds the game's earlier searches, where here each move starts from a cleared one, so a count here can move by a few in play.

7 The next round

Fixed now, before any of its games are played: the candidate praises a held note only when the gate praises it and the live loss is under 1 win%. It is measured by this replay, on the games the archive holds after 2026-10-13, by the same two bars; it is adopted only if it meets both, and the gate as built is measured on the same games beside it.